

best purchased once you arrive at your first stop. For example, you should buy your tickets from Mexico City to Acapulco once you arrive in Mexico City. You'll get lower fares and pay for them with cheap, free-market pesos.

The exception to the "buy locally" rule is when you can get a special, travel-all-you-want deal. Several large countries—Spain, Brazil, Argentina—offer special fares to tourists from abroad. For example, fly on Iberia with an L.A.–Madrid–L.A. ticket, and for only \$200 extra Iberia will give you a sixty-day "See Spain" ticket. Like a Eurorail pass for airplanes, the ticket lets you fly all over Spain without additional charges. The deals change all the time, but many countries offer them—including the United States for those retirees who establish residency abroad. You have to buy these deals before you go, and travel agents know little about them. After all, how many customers do travel agents have who want sixty or ninety days to wander around Brazil? So give your agent a day or two to find out if the country you want to visit has a travel-all-you-want program.

One final point: fly coach. You're on a plane trip, not an ego trip.

LUGGAGE

Travel only with carry-on luggage. It will force you to pack more carefully and think more clearly about what's important to you. With carry-on you never give airlines a chance to lose your luggage. When flights are canceled you'll be able to change flights or carriers at the last minute. You'll be able to check in at the Pan Am Clipper Club or TWA Ambassador Club, if you're flying those airlines and are members of those clubs, rather than waiting in line in the lobby. Perhaps best of all, you'll never be tempted to buy souvenirs or other trinkets—they won't fit into your bags.

Vicki packs her bags with her things and I pack mine with mine. Pack your own and you avoid arguments about what to leave behind.